



*2026 PHARMA AND MED-TECH*

# ***PATIENT SUPPORT BENCHMARK REPORT***

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UNLOCKING THE LARGEST TRENDS IN PATIENT FOCUSED  
STRATEGIES, INNOVATIONS, AND TECHNOLOGY.

# INTRODUCTION

FROM GEORGE KRAMB, CEO OF PATIENTPARTNER

*At PatientPartner, we believe that the future of healthcare lies in a personalized, patient-centric approach that goes beyond traditional engagement methods. With more than **50,000 active users** and a growing network of over 500 mentors, our platform has consistently demonstrated the power of **real-time mentorship** and **patient sentiment analysis** in driving better health outcomes. Over the past several years, we've facilitated thousands of patient-to-mentor connections, resulting in a **71% success rate** in assisting patients to take proactive steps in their health journeys.*

*Today we have created "The State of Patient Engagement in 2026" report to help **pharmaceutical and med-tech companies** understand where they stand in this rapidly evolving landscape. To develop this report we took proprietary insights from our platform, as well as industry and historical data to ensure we had both a robust and unique data set.*

*Our goal is that this comprehensive report serves as both **a benchmarking tool** and **a guide to best practices**, empowering companies to elevate their patient engagement strategies and achieve **above-average performance**.*

*This report is more than just a compilation of industry trends; it's a roadmap for innovation, showing how **mentorship-driven engagement models** and **data-driven strategies** can transform patient care and deliver measurable results. We are excited to share these findings and invite you to join us in shaping the future of healthcare.*

*We hope the information you are able to take away from this is helpful and leads to more innovation within the healthcare industry and your digital transformation initiatives.*



**George Kramb**  
**CEO & Co-Founder | PatientPartner**



# EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

## THE STATE OF PATIENT ENGAGEMENT IN 2026



The landscape of patient engagement has evolved significantly, driven by advancements in digital health and a growing focus on personalized patient experiences. As we enter 2026, pharmaceutical and med-tech companies face increasing pressure to improve patient adherence, retention, and satisfaction through innovative strategies that go beyond traditional methods. The success of leading companies shows that **understanding patient sentiment**, embracing **personalized support**, and implementing **real-time engagement** are key to driving better outcomes. To help organizations stay competitive, this report provides a comprehensive analysis of the current state of patient engagement, offering benchmarking data, insights into emerging trends, and practical strategies for improvement. By leveraging patient sentiment data and insights gained through patient connections and mentorship journeys, companies can achieve **above-average performance** and establish themselves as leaders in patient-centric healthcare.



## BENCHMARKING OVERVIEW AND KEY METRICS EXPLAINED

Benchmarking patient engagement efforts is essential for companies to evaluate their program's performance against industry standards. This section outlines the key metrics that pharmaceutical and med-tech companies should focus on:

- **Adherence Rates:** The percentage of patients who continue their treatment as prescribed. Industry benchmarks show that adherence rates can vary widely, with chronic conditions typically seeing lower adherence than **acute treatments**.
- **Engagement Levels:** Measures the depth and frequency of patient interactions with support programs. Companies with higher engagement rates often implement **multi-channel strategies**, including **mentorship and digital health tools**, to maintain patient interest.



- **Patient Retention:** Indicates how many patients continue to participate in engagement programs over time. Retention is crucial for **long-term adherence** and **positive health outcomes**.
- **Mentor-Patient Connection Success:** Evaluates the effectiveness of mentorship programs in establishing meaningful relationships between patients and mentors.
- **Patient Satisfaction:** A key indicator of the overall quality of the engagement program. High satisfaction scores often correlate with better **adherence rates** and **patient retention**.

Understanding these metrics allows companies to identify where they stand compared to industry averages and **best-in-class performance**. For example, companies that prioritize **real-time mentorship** and **personalized interactions** tend to **achieve above-average adherence rates**, driving significant improvements in **patient outcomes** and overall **brand reputation** for their customers.



#### REFERENCES:

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- Statista: Patient Engagement Statistics

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#### SpringerLink – Benchmarking Patient Engagement Capabilities:

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## CURRENT TRENDS SHAPING PATIENT ENGAGEMENT IN 2026

The healthcare industry is experiencing a **paradigm shift** towards **patient-centric models**, largely driven by **digital health innovations** and the need for **personalized support**. Key trends in 2026 include:

- **Personalized Patient Support:** Patients increasingly expect healthcare providers to deliver **tailored experiences** that address their unique needs and circumstances. Programs like **LillyDirect** and **PfizerForAll** have set new standards by providing **personalized resources and support** to help patients manage their treatments.
- **Mentorship Programs:** Mentorship-based engagement models are gaining traction as companies realize the value of connecting patients with mentors who have experienced similar health challenges. This approach fosters **empathy**, improves **adherence**, and leads to **better health outcomes**.
- **Technological Innovations:** Advances in **AI-powered patient sentiment analysis**, **real-time engagement tools**, and **predictive modeling** enable companies to better understand patient behaviors and optimize their engagement strategies. These tools allow for more **targeted outreach** and **timely interventions**.

### COMPARISON OF LEADING PATIENT ENGAGEMENT SOLUTIONS

As the landscape of patient engagement continues to evolve, several companies have integrated modern strategies to meet the changing needs of patients. While each solution offers a unique approach, there are clear distinctions in how they address patient support. Below, we compare the strengths and limitations of **PatientPartner** and its competitors to demonstrate why **PatientPartner** stands out as the leading solution for patient engagement.



# PatientPartner

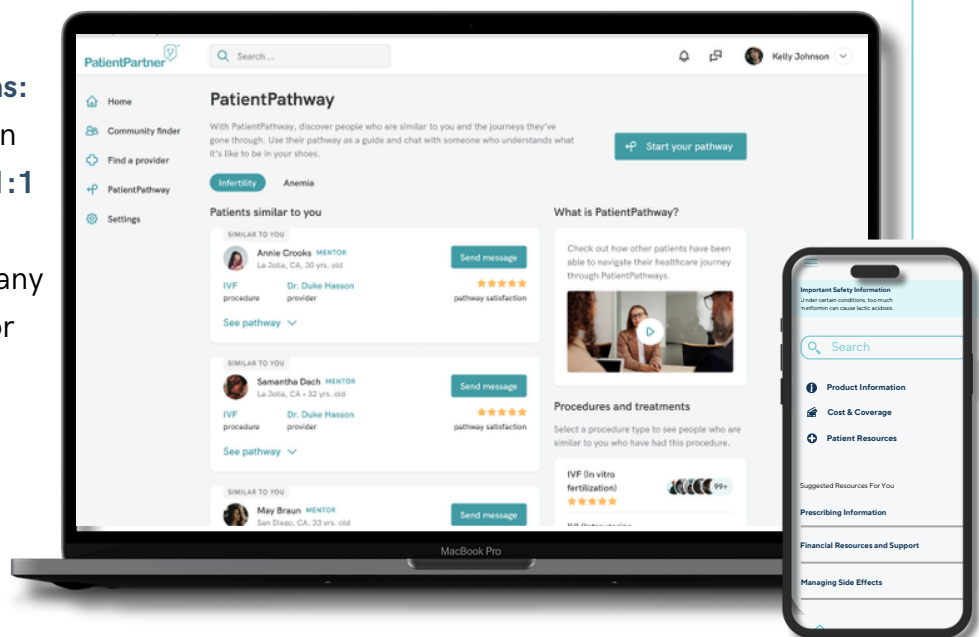
**Overview:** PatientPartner is a next-generation patient engagement platform that connects patients with real-time mentorship from individuals who have undergone similar health experiences. The platform integrates **patient sentiment analysis**, **predictive modeling**, and **personalized mentorship programs** to deliver superior patient support.

## STRENGTHS

- **Real-Time Mentorship:** Provides patients with immediate access to mentors who can offer personalized advice and emotional support, enhancing engagement and adherence.
- **Sentiment-Driven Interventions:** Uses **patient sentiment data** to tailor outreach and adapt strategies dynamically, ensuring that support is relevant and timely.
- **High Adherence and Satisfaction Rates:** Achieves industry-leading metrics in patient adherence, with programs consistently reporting **25-30% higher Net Promoter Scores (NPS)** compared to traditional support models.
- **Cost-Effective and Scalable:** Offers a more **affordable alternative** to large-scale direct-to-patient marketing campaigns, with **faster implementation times** and **easier onboarding**.

## LIMITATIONS

- **Focus on 1:1 Connections:** The platform specializes in **real-time, personalized 1:1 mentorship** and does not currently support 1-to-many connections like forums or group discussions.





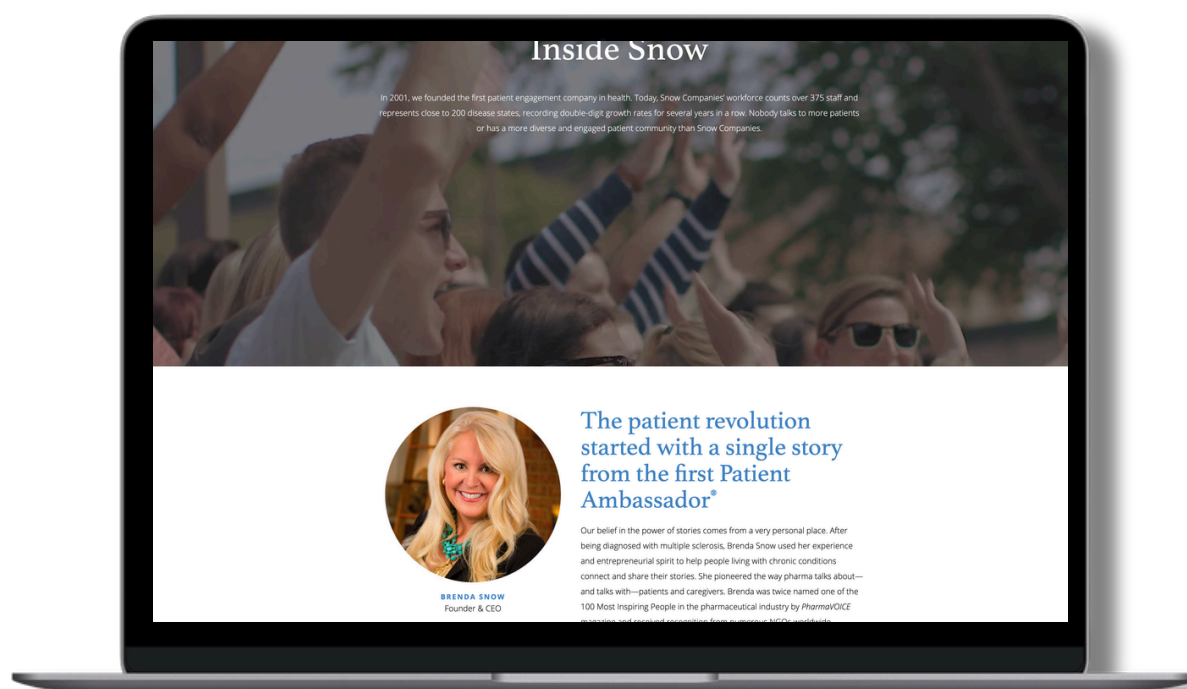
**Overview:** Snow Companies is known for its **advocacy-based patient engagement** model, focusing primarily on patient storytelling and creating educational content. The approach centers around sharing patient experiences through various channels to promote awareness and support.

## STRENGTHS

- **Storytelling and Advocacy:** Uses powerful storytelling to raise awareness and build community support for specific conditions.
- **Patient Ambassadors:** Leverages patient ambassadors to educate and engage others, creating a sense of shared experience.

## LIMITATIONS

- **Less Focus on Personalized Mentorship:** The approach is primarily advocacy-driven, with limited emphasis on one-on-one mentorship or real-time patient support.
- **Static Engagement:** Tends to focus on content **creation rather** than adaptive or **dynamic engagement strategies**, potentially limiting its impact on immediate adherence.







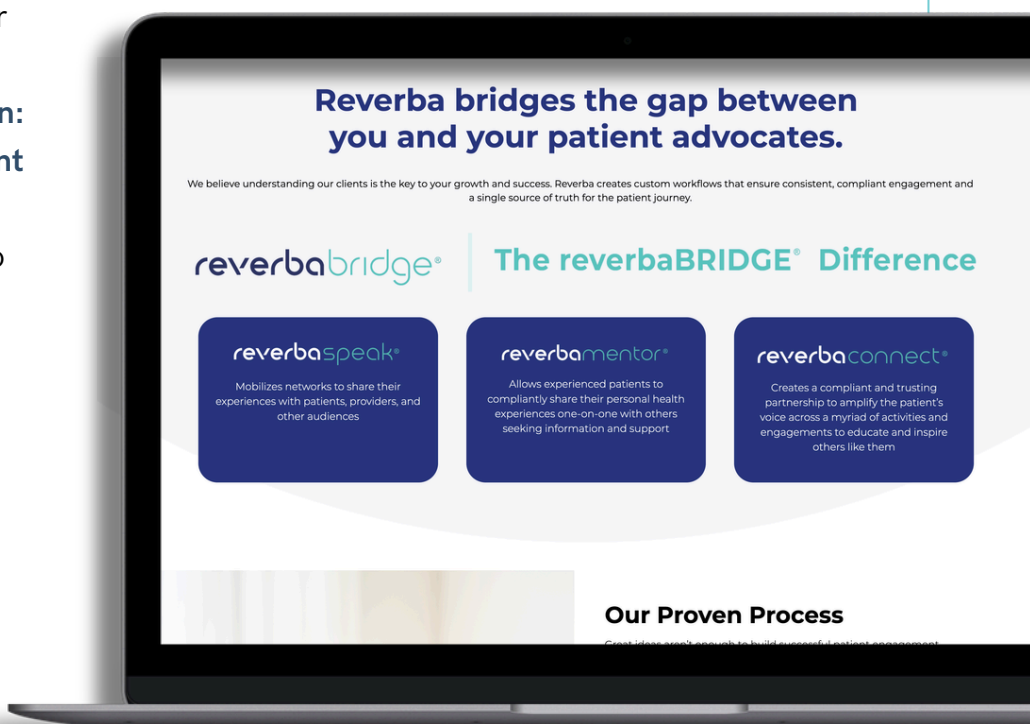
**Overview:** Reverba specializes in **patient engagement programs** for the life sciences industry, often focusing on patient education and recruitment for clinical trials. The platform provides a **standardized approach** to patient support with educational resources and communication plans.

## STRENGTHS

- **Clinical Trial Recruitment:** Offers tailored programs for recruiting patients into clinical trials and **educating them** on treatment options.
- **Standardized Support Programs:** Provides structured educational content and patient communication plans.

## LIMITATIONS

- **Limited Personalization:** Uses a more **standardized approach** that may not meet the needs of patients seeking **personalized** guidance or emotional support.
- **Less Dynamic Adaptation:** Lacks **real-time sentiment analysis**, making it less effective in responding to changes in patient engagement needs.





[www.patientslikeme.com](http://www.patientslikeme.com)

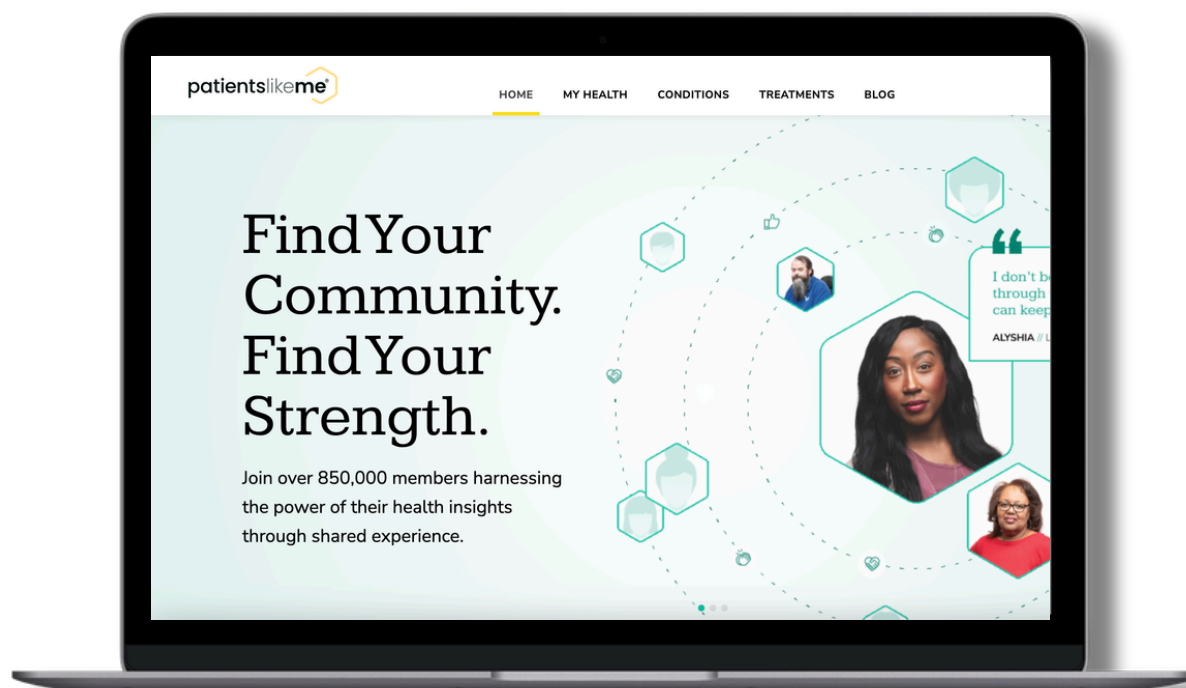
**Overview: PatientsLikeMe** is a social health network that allows patients to **share experiences, track health conditions**, and connect with others facing similar challenges. It offers a platform for large-scale data sharing and community-based support.

## STRENGTHS

- **Community Support:** Provides a **broad network** for patients to connect and share experiences with a **large community** across various conditions.
- **Health Tracking Tools:** Offers tools for patients to track symptoms and **monitor progress**, giving users a way to manage their conditions.

## LIMITATIONS

- **Generalized Support:** The platform's **broad focus** on many conditions may dilute the depth of support for specific patient needs.
- **Limited Mentorship and Real-Time Interaction:** Lacks the **one-on-one mentorship** and **real-time feedback** that are crucial for driving **personalized patient engagement**.



# WHY PatientPartner<sup>®</sup> STANDS OUT

By choosing PatientPartner, companies can elevate their patient engagement strategies to not only meet industry standards PatientPartner goes beyond traditional advocacy, standardized programs, and community networks by combining real-time mentorship, sentiment-driven insights, and predictive modeling. These features ensure that each patient receives personalized support tailored to their unique health journey, resulting in better adherence rates, satisfaction, and health outcomes. While some platforms offer 1-to-many engagement options like forums, PatientPartner's focus on 1:1 connections allows for deeper, more impactful patient interactions. With cost-effective, scalable solutions and a focus on dynamic engagement, PatientPartner sets new benchmarks for patient-centric care. but also lead the way in delivering meaningful patient support and treatment adherence.

## Industry Partners Benefits

### Marketing Teams

We help new patients **understand the benefits of your product** by connecting them with experienced mentors, boosting patient awareness.

- ✓ Patient Acquisition
- ✓ Patient Education
- ✓ Script Lift

# 18%

Script lift when patients are matched with a mentor

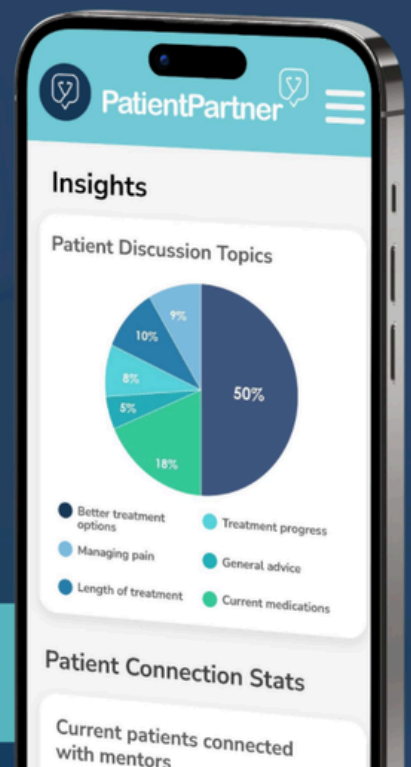
### Patient Service Teams

We provide newly prescribed patients a mentor during the onboarding process to **increase drug & treatment adherence.**

- ✓ Drug Adherence
- ✓ Onboarding Experience
- ✓ Brand Loyalty

# 22%

Increase in treatment adherence when patients are matched with a mentor



#### REFERENCES:

- Digital Health Innovations - Rock Health



# EXAMINING HISTORICAL AVENUES FOR PATIENT FEEDBACK AND CONNECTION

Over the years, patients have sought various avenues for sharing feedback, connecting with others, and finding support for health-related issues. These methods have evolved, reflecting changes in technology and social behaviors. Below, we explore some of the most commonly used avenues for patient feedback and connection, their characteristics, and their limitations.

1

## Facebook Groups

- **Definition:** Online communities where individuals share experiences and offer support related to health conditions, varying in focus and size.
- **Limitations:** There are significant privacy concerns due to the public or semi-public nature of these groups. Inconsistent moderation can lead to the spread of misinformation or unvetted medical advice, potentially causing harm.

2

## Web Forums & Blogs

- **Definition:** Platforms that offer discussion spaces for health-related topics, personal stories, and advice across various health conditions.
- **Limitations:** These platforms often lack personalization, and discussions may not be moderated, leading to off-topic conversations and varied information quality. There are also significant privacy risks and potential for misinformation.

3

## In-person Community Interactions

- **Definition:** Traditional settings such as support groups, health workshops, and therapy sessions that provide direct human connection and shared experiences.
- **Limitations:** Accessibility is a key issue, with geographical constraints limiting reach. Additionally, stigma or physical barriers may prevent some individuals from participating, and these options require a time commitment that may not suit everyone's needs.

4

## Automated Chatbots and Messengers

- **Definition:** Digital tools integrated into patient-facing websites that provide automated responses and basic support through AI.
- **Limitations:** These tools often lack the depth and personalization needed for addressing complex health issues, delivering generic responses that may not fully satisfy individual needs. Users may experience frustration with AI's limitations and the inability to escalate to a human for more nuanced support.

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# FINDINGS AND GAPS IN HISTORICAL SOLUTIONS

Upon reviewing historical approaches to patient feedback and connection, several consistent gaps emerge:

1

**Privacy Concerns:** Platforms like Facebook Groups and web forums do not always prioritize privacy, which can lead to discomfort and reluctance to share sensitive health information.

2

**Lack of Personalization:** Most historical solutions, such as chatbots or general web forums, provide generic advice or responses that do not consider individual patient histories or specific needs, resulting in less effective support.

3

**Inconsistent Quality of Information:** Unmoderated or semi-moderated environments often have inconsistent quality of content, leading to misinformation or the spread of unverified advice.

4

**Accessibility Barriers:** In-person community interactions can be challenging for those with geographical, physical, or time-related constraints, limiting their reach and inclusiveness.

5

**Depth of Engagement:** Automated solutions like chatbots may offer convenience, but they lack the human touch needed for complex health discussions and emotional support, while peer-to-peer forums may not provide structured guidance.

These gaps highlight the limitations of traditional models in addressing the evolving needs of today's patients, who seek more personalized, secure, and meaningful support options.



## REFERENCES:

- Edelman. (2023). Edelman Trust Barometer: Trust and Health. (2023 Edelman Trust Baro...)





## INDUSTRY AVERAGES VS. BEST-IN-CLASS PRACTICES

To achieve **best-in-class performance**, companies must move beyond industry averages and embrace strategies that have been proven to deliver results. For instance, **average adherence rates for chronic conditions** typically range from **50-60%**, while **top-performing companies** that implement **real-time mentorship** and patient support systems often achieve adherence rates closer to **75-80%**. This improvement is driven by two main factors: the **increased accessibility** to care support through mentorship and the **enhanced personal accountability** created by patient support interventions, such as mentorship programs. These factors work together to make patients more likely to stay engaged with their treatment plans and adhere to recommended care.

Leading companies in the industry, such as **Eli Lilly** and **Pfizer**, have set new standards with initiatives like **LillyDirect** and **PfizerForAll**, which focus on **direct-to-patient strategies**. By adopting **multi-channel patient engagement approaches**, incorporating **digital tools, personalized support, and mentorship programs**, these companies have successfully achieved **higher patient satisfaction and retention rates**. Moreover, the shift toward **direct-to-consumer (DTC) marketing** has increased consumer sentiment and awareness around their treatment solutions. While specific data may vary, DTC marketing campaigns in the **pharmaceutical industry** often represent a significant portion of overall marketing spend, with estimates suggesting that **DTC advertising budgets** exceed **\$6 billion annually** in the U.S. alone, according to data from the **Kaiser Family Foundation**. This investment has been shown to effectively boost **brand awareness** and **patient engagement**, helping companies to better connect with their target audiences.

## EFFECTIVENESS OF DIRECT-TO-CONSUMER (DTC) PATIENT MARKETING

**DTC marketing** plays a crucial role in patient engagement strategies, with several studies indicating its effectiveness in raising awareness and influencing patient behavior. Key statistics include:

- **Increased Patient Awareness:** According to the **Journal of the American Board of Family Medicine (JABFM)**, **76%** of patients are likely to ask a healthcare provider about an advertised drug, and **26%** have already done so. Additionally, **20%** of patients reported discussing new medical conditions with their provider due to DTC ads.
- **Budget Allocation:** Pharmaceutical companies in the U.S. spent over **\$7 billion annually** on DTC advertising, mostly on TV and digital platforms, reflecting their commitment to patient outreach (Kaiser Family Foundation, 2003) (Kaiser Health News, 2017)
- **Impact on Treatment Discussions:** The **JABFM** study found that **16%** of patients who discussed an advertised drug received a prescription for it, and **33%** specifically requested the advertised drug.



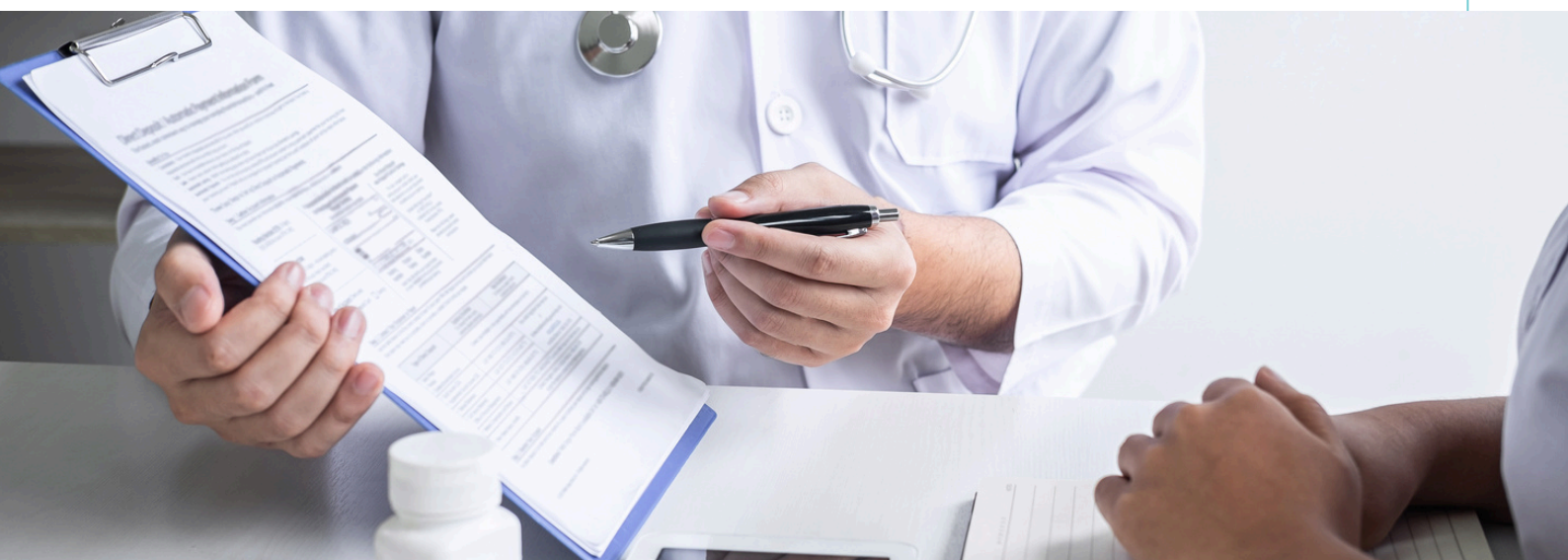
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- Sullivan, H. W., Aikin, K. J., Berkthold, J., Stein, K. L., & Hoverman, V. J. (2020). Direct-to-consumer prescription drug advertising and patient-provider interactions. *The Journal of the American Board of Family Medicine*, 33(2), 279-283. <https://doi.org/10.3122/jabfm.2020.02.190278>
- Kaiser Health News. (2017, March 20). Prescription drug costs are on the rise; so are the TV ads promoting them. *KFF Health News*. <https://kffhealthnews.org/news/prescription-drug-costs-are-on-the-rise-so-are-the-tv-ads-promoting-them/>
- Kaiser Family Foundation. (2003). *Impact of direct-to-consumer advertising on prescription drug spending*. The Henry J. Kaiser Family Foundation. . <https://www.kff.org/wp-content/uploads/2003/06/6084-impact-of-direct-to-consumer-advertising-on-prescription-drug-spending-summary-of-findings.pdf>
- These investments highlight the power of **DTC strategies** to reach patients, but they also come with challenges, such as high costs and long lead times to develop and launch campaigns.

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- Kaiser Health News. (2017, March 20). Prescription drug costs are on the rise; so are the TV ads promoting them. *KFF Health News*. <https://kffhealthnews.org/news/prescription-drug-costs-are-on-the-rise-so-are-the-tv-ads-promoting-them/>
- Kaiser Family Foundation. (2003). *Impact of direct-to-consumer advertising on prescription drug spending*. The Henry J. Kaiser Family Foundation. . <https://www.kff.org/wp-content/uploads/2003/06/6084-impact-of-direct-to-consumer-advertising-on-prescription-drug-spending-summary-of-findings.pdf>
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## PARTICIPATING IN DIRECT-TO-PATIENT STRATEGIES WITHOUT A MAJOR COMPANY BUDGET

You don't have to be a **major company** like **Eli Lilly** or **Pfizer** to develop an effective **direct-to-patient strategy**. Solutions like **PatientPartner** provide a **cost-effective and accessible alternative** for companies looking to enhance patient engagement without the need for multi-million-dollar marketing budgets.

**PatientPartner** offers a **fraction of the cost** and provides a **faster time-to-market**, allowing companies to launch direct-to-patient initiatives with ease. Unlike traditional **DTC marketing efforts**, which may require substantial resources and extensive planning, **PatientPartner's platform** delivers an **efficient and scalable solution**. Companies can quickly onboard the platform and begin connecting patients with mentors who can offer **personalized guidance**, thus improving patient adherence and overall satisfaction. By **benchmarking their metrics** against high-performing companies, organizations can identify **gaps in their programs** and focus on strategies that are most effective in **improving patient engagement**. Leveraging tools like **PatientPartner** allows companies to implement **direct-to-patient strategies** without the need for a **large marketing budget**, achieving similar benefits in terms of patient support and outcomes.

This revised section covers the updated content while providing a clear comparison between **large-scale DTC strategies** and more **accessible options** like **PatientPartner**, offering valuable insights for companies of all sizes.

### REFERENCES:

#### Kaiser Family Foundation – Prescription Drug Advertising

- Overview of DTC spending and its impact on patient behavior.
- Kaiser Family Foundation: Prescription Drug Advertising

#### Statista – U.S. DTC Pharmaceutical Advertising Spending

- Provides data on annual DTC ad spending in the U.S. pharmaceutical industry.
- Statista: DTC Pharmaceutical Advertising Spending

#### FDA – Impact of Direct-to-Consumer Advertising

- Discusses the effects of DTC advertising on patient awareness and treatment discussions with healthcare providers.
- FDA: Impact of DTC Advertising

#### Journal of the American Medical Association (JAMA) – Effects of DTC Advertising

- Provides studies and reviews about the impact of DTC advertising on healthcare and patient behavior.
- JAMA: Effects of DTC Advertising

#### Harvard Business Review – How Pharma Can Use DTC Advertising

- Discusses strategic approaches to using DTC advertising in the pharmaceutical industry.
- *Harvard Business Review: How Pharma Can Use DTC Advertising*

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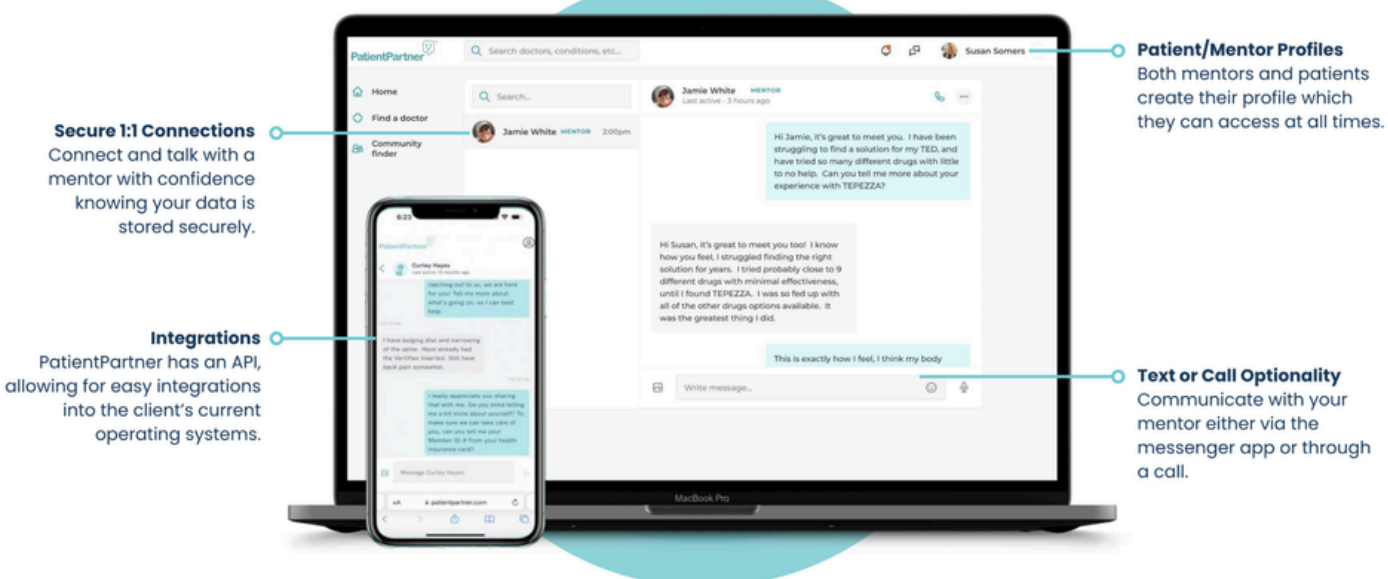
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## Technology Overview

### The MentorConnect Platform



# CASE STUDIES: COMPANIES LEADING THE WAY IN PATIENT ENGAGEMENT

This section features case studies from top-performing companies in the pharmaceutical and med-tech industries, highlighting their approaches to patient engagement, the challenges they faced, and the results they achieved:

## LILLYDIRECT- (WWW.LILLYDIRECT.COM)

- **www.lillydirect.com Challenge:** Improving adherence for patients on chronic medications.
- **Solution:** Implemented a multi-channel support program that included digital tools, personalized patient resources, and improved access to medication through direct delivery services. This initiative aimed to make medication management more convenient for patients while providing resources for ongoing support.
- **Outcome:** Increased patient access to medications and provided a more integrated approach to managing long-term conditions. This initiative positioned Lilly to enhance its patient-centric strategies and offer more tailored support to its customers.



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- Lilly's Patient Support Programs
- LillyDirect Information

Medical Design & Development – LillyDirect Digital Healthcare Platform:

Medical Design & Development. (2024, January 4). Lilly launches digital healthcare platform through LillyDirect. Medical Design & Development. Retrieved October 16, 2024, from <https://www.medicaldesigndevelopment.com/news/news/22882989/lilly-launches-digital-healthcare-platform-through-lillydirect>

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LillyDirect Official Website: Eli Lilly and Company. (2024). LillyDirect online pharmacy solution & virtual care. LillyDirect. from <https://lillydirect.lilly.com/>

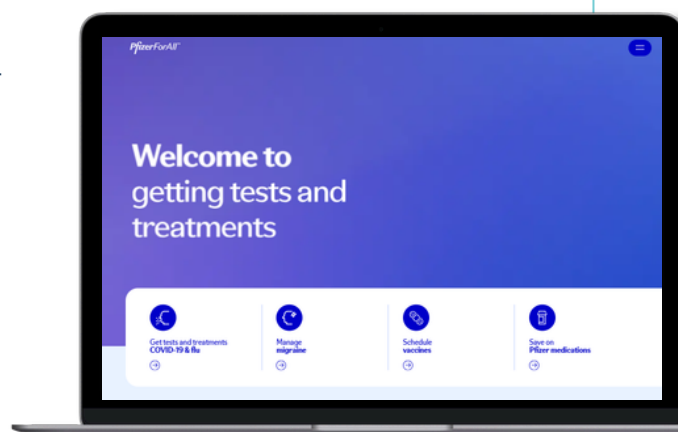


## PFIZERFORALL: [WWW.PFIZERFORALL.COM](http://WWW.PFIZERFORALL.COM)

- **Challenge:** Enhancing patient retention in support programs and ensuring equitable access to specialty medications.
- **Solution:** Launched the PfizerForAll program to provide affordable access to Pfizer's medications and support resources, including patient assistance programs and online educational materials. The initiative focused on reducing cost barriers and offering more comprehensive patient support.
- **Outcome:** The program increased medication accessibility for underserved populations, improved patient satisfaction through financial support, and strengthened Pfizer's commitment to patient-centered care.

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- Pfizer's Patient Assistance Programs
- [PfizerForAll Program Overview](#)
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- Pfizer Inc. (2024). PfizerForAll online platform. PfizerForAll. <https://www.pfizerforall.com>
- Pfizer - Launch of PfizerForAll Platform:
- Pfizer Inc. (2024, August 27). PfizerForAll strives to simplify how you access healthcare. Pfizer. Retrieved October 16, 2024, from <https://www.pfizer.com/news/announcements/pfizerforall-strives-simplify-how-you-access-healthcare>



## PATIENTSLIKEME

- **Challenge:** Providing a broad and scalable platform for patients to share experiences and track health conditions across a wide range of illnesses.
- **Solution:** Developed a health-specific social network that enables users to share detailed health information, track symptoms, and connect with others facing similar conditions. The platform supports large-scale data sharing and community discussions, allowing patients to engage in peer support and self-management.
- **Outcome:** Built a community of over 830,000 members, covering more than 2,800 conditions, with users reporting improvements in self-management and knowledge about their conditions. However, engagement often remained limited to group discussions rather than personalized, one-on-one connections.

### REFERENCES:

- PatientsLikeMe Community Overview
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## PATIENTPARTNER

- **Challenge:** Bridging the gap between patient expectations and engagement outcomes.
- **Solution:** Introduced a real-time mentorship platform that uses patient sentiment analysis to personalize interactions and match patients with mentors who have experienced similar health journeys.
- **Outcome:** Achieved a **71% success rate** in driving patients to take actionable steps in their healthcare journey, resulting in improved adherence and more proactive health management.

### REFERENCES:

- Examples from Patient-Centric Initiatives - FiercePharma

## Competition

|                       | Other Mentorship Programs             | PatientPartner  |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Waiting Time          | - 6 weeks to chat with mentor         | + 6 hrs/48 hrs to chat with mentor                                                                   |
| Patient Drop Off Rate | - 35% Patient drop off rate           | + 100% mentor match rate                                                                             |
| Scope of Reporting    | - No Insights to conversation context | + Real-time metrics on convo. topics & next steps                                                    |
| Process               | - Manual & inefficient process        | + Personalized & streamlined engagement platform                                                     |



# THE IMPACT OF PATIENT SENTIMENT ON ENGAGEMENT AND ADHERENCE

In the evolving landscape of patient engagement, leveraging **patient sentiment** has become a pivotal factor in understanding patient behaviors, emotions, and treatment motivations. Sentiment analysis empowers healthcare companies to enhance engagement by anticipating patient needs and delivering **timely, personalized interventions**.

## WHY SENTIMENT ANALYSIS MATTERS

- **Deeper Understanding of Patient Behavior:** Sentiment analysis provides insights that go beyond demographics, revealing the emotional drivers behind patient actions. This allows companies to anticipate challenges, such as potential disengagement, and intervene proactively (1) (2).
- **Predictive Modeling:** Using sentiment data in **predictive models** helps identify at-risk patients and tailor support accordingly. This personalized approach enables companies to address patient concerns before they escalate, improving the quality of care (3) (4).
- **Dynamic Engagement:** Real-time feedback and sentiment-driven adjustments have been shown to significantly improve engagement compared to static methods like email or SMS, which typically generate response rates of 10-20%. While exact numbers can vary, dynamic approaches such as real-time feedback often lead to much higher engagement rates, with some sources reporting SMS click-through rates between 21-35% (6) (7). Continuous refinement based on sentiment analysis helps strengthen patient relationships and boosts adherence (8)



## BENEFITS OF INTEGRATING SENTIMENT DATA

- **Enhanced Adherence and Outcomes:** Companies that integrate sentiment data into patient engagement frameworks can **boost adherence rates**, resulting in better long-term health outcomes and increased patient satisfaction (1) (9).
- **Competitive Advantage:** Leveraging patient sentiment allows companies to understand their audience on a deeper level and differentiate themselves by offering **patient-centric, personalized support** (3) (10).



### REFERENCES:

- **Health Affairs – Importance of Patient Sentiment**

Can't find the specific resource from Health Affairs so these are the alternative sites validating the same points:

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2. Artera. (2024). The importance of sentiment analysis in healthcare. Artera. Retrieved October 17, 2024, from <https://artera.io/blog/sentiment-analysis-in-healthcare/>
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## COMMON PITFALLS AND AREAS FOR IMPROVEMENT

Despite advances in patient engagement strategies, certain pitfalls frequently hinder progress. Addressing these challenges is crucial for optimizing patient interactions and outcomes.

1

### Over-Automation

- **Challenge:** While automation can scale outreach, it often makes patient interactions feel impersonal. According to research, 63% of patients worry that the use of AI reduces face-to-face time with healthcare providers, leading to a decline in trust and engagement [\(1\)](#) [\(2\)](#).
- **Solution:** Incorporate human-to-human elements in the engagement strategy, such as mentorship programs or live support. Companies that adopt real-time mentorship programs report an average 25% increase in Net Promoter Scores (NPS), indicating higher levels of patient satisfaction [\(3\)](#).

2

### Failure to Personalize Outreach

- **Challenge:** Generic messaging can disengage patients, as it does not address individual experiences. A study by Perficient reveals that 68% of healthcare executives prioritize personalized communication, a significant increase from 21% before the pandemic [\(4\)](#).
- **Solution:** Use patient data and sentiment analysis to personalize messages and interventions, resulting in more meaningful engagement and higher adherence rates [\(4\)](#).

3

### Neglecting Feedback

- **Challenge:** Ignoring patient feedback or failing to act on sentiment data can lead to missed opportunities for improving the patient experience. Research shows that 80% of patients report response speed as one of the most important factors in healthcare satisfaction [\(3\)](#).
- **Solution:** Implement a real-time feedback system to continuously adapt engagement strategies based on patient input, improving responsiveness and satisfaction [\(3\)](#) [\(1\)](#).

#### REFERENCES:

- **PharmaVOICE – Challenges in Patient Engagement**

1. Medical Economics. (2023). Patients don't understand use of AI in health care, and many don't trust it. Medical Economics. Retrieved October 17, 2024, from <https://www.medicaleconomics.com/view/patients-dont-understand-use-of-ai-in-health-care-and-many-dont-trust-it>
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## STRATEGIES FOR OVERCOMING COMMON PITFALLS

To maximize patient engagement and avoid common pitfalls, companies should focus on personalization, **real-time feedback**, and **human connection**. Here are key strategies:

1

### Leverage Predictive Modeling

- **Anticipate Needs:** Use sentiment data to predict patient behaviors and identify at-risk patients. This enables early intervention with personalized support.
- **Improve Outcomes:** Target resources effectively to enhance engagement and boost long-term health outcomes by addressing potential issues before they escalate.

2

### Integrate Mentorship Programs

- **Humanize Engagement:** Connect patients with mentors who have faced similar challenges, providing emotional and practical support that resonates on a personal level.
- **Personalize Based on Data:** Tailor mentorship based on patient sentiment and health history, ensuring the support aligns with individual needs.
- **Boost Satisfaction and Trust:** Mentorship fosters empathy and trust, leading to higher satisfaction, increased treatment adherence, and improved Net Promoter Scores (NPS).

3

### Adapt Engagement in Real Time

- **Respond Quickly to Feedback:** Use real-time sentiment analysis to adjust strategies dynamically, addressing patient concerns as they arise.
- **Deliver Relevant Support:** Ensure timely responses to patient needs, demonstrating attentiveness and commitment to patient-centered care.
- **Enhance Retention:** Dynamic engagement informed by real-time feedback helps maintain high patient retention by continuously optimizing the experience.



# OPPORTUNITIES FOR GROWTH AND IMPROVEMENT IN 2026

Healthcare companies can enhance patient engagement by embracing key growth areas in 2026, including **digital transformation**, **mentorship-based models**, and **patient-centric strategies**.

1

## Digital Transformation (1, 2, 3)

- **Data-Driven Strategies:** Leverage **predictive analytics** and **machine learning** to anticipate patient needs and personalize support, improving outcomes.
- **AI and Automation:** Strategic use of **AI tools** like chatbots can enhance engagement while reducing administrative workload, maintaining a balance between automation and human interaction.
- **Remote Monitoring and Telehealth:** Use **telehealth services** and **real-time data collection** to keep patients engaged, adjusting care as needed to maintain continuous support.

2

## Mentorship-Based Models

- **Shift from Traditional Programs:** Move towards **mentorship-driven approaches** that offer relatable guidance from those with similar experiences, leading to higher adherence and satisfaction.
- **Real-Time Matching:** Match patients with mentors based on shared conditions in real time to provide timely and relevant support.
- **Measurable Impact:** Mentorship programs show significant improvements in **adherence rates** and **Net Promoter Scores (NPS)**, offering a personalized and effective alternative to static support strategies.

3

## Patient-Centric Strategies (2)

- **Focus on Individual Needs:** Personalize care by using sentiment data to tailor interventions, resulting in higher satisfaction and better outcomes.
- **Differentiate from Competitors:** Adopt a **patient-centric approach** to stand out in the market, demonstrating a commitment to quality care.
- **Integrate Feedback Loops:** Use consistent feedback from patients to adapt strategies and show responsiveness to patient needs, building loyalty and engagement.

## 4

**Expanding Digital Health Solutions (4, 3)**

- **Emerging Technologies:** Utilize **wearables**, **apps**, and **digital therapeutics** to empower patients to manage their care.
- **Collaborative Ecosystems:** Integrate with **EHRs** and other digital tools for a seamless patient-provider experience, enhancing coordination and care delivery.

By pursuing these opportunities, companies can close engagement gaps and achieve better outcomes through personalized, responsive, and innovative patient care.

**REFERENCES:**

- [Deloitte – Growth Trends in Digital Health](#)

**1. Digital Transformation in Healthcare:**

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**3. Measuring Digital Transformation ROI:**

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## HOW PATIENTPARTNER CAN HELP YOU CLOSE THE GAP AND STAY AHEAD

**PatientPartner's platform** offers a comprehensive approach to closing engagement gaps by leveraging **mentorship**, **real-time engagement**, and **patient sentiment analysis**:

- **Real-Time Mentor Matching:** Connects patients with mentors who have firsthand experience in similar health journeys, providing **personalized support**.
- **Predictive Engagement Tools:** Use **sentiment data** to identify patients who may need extra support, ensuring timely interventions.
- **Measurable Outcomes:** Demonstrates **improved adherence rates**, **patient satisfaction**, and **ROI** for pharma and med-tech companies.

A case study of a company that adopted **PatientPartner's solutions** showed a **25% increase in patient retention** within six months.

### REFERENCES:

- [PatientPartner Solutions Overview](#)

## BOOK A CONSULTATION AND AUDIT WITH PATIENTPARTNER



*George Kramb*  
**CEO & Co-Founder | PatientPartner**

To stay competitive and achieve best-in-class performance, **schedule a consultation and audit of your direct-to-patient initiatives and patient engagement strategies** with our CEO, **George Kramb**. Let us help guide you towards **higher adherence rates**, **improved patient outcomes**, and a **better ROI**.

Book your consultation today and discover how **PatientPartner** can elevate your patient engagement approach to the next level.